Terms of Reference (ToR)

Contracting a Firm to Develop and Deliver Two E-Learning Courses on Digital Accessibility and Disability Inclusion

1. Description of the Assignment / Background

Bangladesh has made significant progress in digital transformation through e-governance, digital public services, online education, and innovation ecosystems. However, the recent study (Accessibility Matters: A Review of Disability Inclusion in Bangladesh's Digital Ecosystem) shows that despite these advancements, digital platforms remain largely inaccessible to persons with disabilities, limiting their equal participation in education, employment, and public life.

Persons with disabilities constitute approximately 15% (WHO) of the global population, and a significant proportion in Bangladesh continues to face barriers due to inaccessible digital systems. Challenges such as lack of screen reader compatibility, poor navigation structures, absence of captions, and inaccessible digital documents contribute to widening the digital divide.

The Government of Bangladesh has taken important steps through the Rights and Protection of Persons with Disabilities Act 2013 and the Web Accessibility Guidelines 2022, alongside commitments to global frameworks such as the UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (UNCRPD) and the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). However, gaps remain in awareness, technical capacity, and institutional adoption of accessibility standards such as WCAG.

Despite these policy advancements, capacity-building efforts on digital accessibility remain fragmented, with limited structured training available for government officials, developers, and policymakers. Furthermore, there is currently no dedicated or standardized curriculum at the university level that systematically addresses digital accessibility and disability inclusion, resulting in a shortage of skilled professionals and limited integration of accessibility principles in mainstream ICT education. Scalable, standardized e-learning solutions are therefore required.

To address these challenges, this initiative proposes the development and delivery of two structured e-learning courses:

- Digital Accessibility Training (DAT)
- Disability and Digital Inclusion Training (DDT)

The purpose of this assignment is to engage a qualified implementation partner to design, develop, and deliver these courses, ensuring high-quality, accessible, and scalable learning solutions that promote inclusive digital transformation in Bangladesh.

2. Objectives

The primary objectives of this assignment is to:

- Build the technical capacity of at least 300 participants in accessible design and development practices.
- Improve participants' knowledge scores by at least 30% between pre- and post-assessments.
- Promote adoption of national and international accessibility standards in digital services.
- Support policymakers and institutions to integrate disability inclusion into digital policies and programs.
- Encourage meaningful participation of persons with disabilities in the digital ecosystem.

3. Scope of Work

The firm will be responsible for delivering a comprehensive e-learning program consisting of two structured courses, ensuring accessibility, quality, and scalability.

3.1. Curriculum Design & Course Development

• Finalize course audio-visual contents, structure, and learning outcomes for DAT and DDT

• Conduct consultations with government stakeholders, Organizations of Persons with Disabilities (OPDs), experts, and relevant institutions

• Develop detailed module outlines (25–30 modules), All modules must follow a standardized template including: introduction, learning objectives, core content, example/demo, summary, and quiz. Use of existing open-source materials, frameworks, and templates is encouraged where appropriate.

• Prepare scripts, storyboards, and instructional design frameworks

3.2. Development of Training Courses

Course 1: Digital Accessibility Training (DAT)

Focus: Technical skills development

Modules will include:

1. Digital accessibility fundamentals
2. Assistive technologies
3. Accessible web and mobile design
4. Accessible documents and multimedia
5. Accessibility testing and evaluation
6. AI and accessibility

• Include practical demonstrations and case studies

Course 2: Disability and Digital Inclusion Training (DDT)

Focus: Policy, awareness, and inclusion

Modules will include:

• Disability inclusion and inclusive development

• Digital divide and inclusive transformation
• Rights-based approaches (national & global frameworks)
• Inclusive policies and governance
• Participation of persons with disabilities
• Inclusive innovation and assistive technology

3.3. Content Production

The implementation partner will develop a complete and deployment-ready course package aligned with MuktoPaath platform requirements:

Course Content Development

• Course title (Bangla & English)
• Course description and objectives
• Clearly defined target audience
• Detailed course outline with structured module sequencing

Audio-Visual Production

• Video lectures and demonstrations (16:9 ratio, minimum HD 1080p)
• Promo video (maximum 1 minute duration)
• Ensure high-quality production standards, including editing, sound design, and visual clarity suitable for digital learning

Instructional Materials

• Scripts for all video content (Bangla Unicode text where applicable)
• Reading materials (DOC and PDF formats)
• Downloadable resources (minimum 40+)

Assessment & Evaluation

• Module-wise quizzes and assessment questions with correct answers
• Course evaluation/feedback form

Visual & Branding Assets

• Course thumbnail (750 × 422 pixels)
• Certificate design (3508 × 2480 pixels; .ai & .png)

Accessibility Compliance

Bidders must include a costed accessibility plan.

• Subtitles (SRT format)
- Transcripts

• Sign language (where feasible for key modules)
• Captioned and transcribed multimedia

• Screen reader-friendly documents

• Ensure full compliance with WCAG 2.2 AA standards

3.4. Platform Integration & Accessibility Compliance

• Upload and configure all course components on the MuktoPaath platform in coordination with a2i.

• Ensure proper structuring of:

- Course metadata (title, description, objectives, target audience)
- Module sequencing and navigation
- Assessment configuration and certification criteria

• Ensure platform-level accessibility compliance:

- Screen reader compatibility
- Keyboard navigation
- Captioned and transcribed videos
- Proper use of alt text and semantic structure

• Ensure all uploaded materials follow MuktoPaath technical and formatting standards.

3.5. Pilot Testing & Quality Assurance

- Conduct pilot testing with diverse participants, including persons with disabilities.
- Collect feedback and refine course content.
- Ensure usability and accessibility validation.

3.6. Training of Trainers (ToT)

- Design and deliver ToT sessions for at least 20 trainers.
- Build trainers' capacity in both technical and facilitation skills.

3.7. Training Delivery & Monitoring

1. Courses will be launched and participants enrolled by a2i, with a target of at least 500 participants.
2. Monitor participation, engagement, and completion rates throughout the course lifecycle.
3. Achieve a target course completion rate of 60–70%, ensuring effective learning outcomes.
4. Track learner engagement through indicators such as frequency of logins, time spent on the platform, module-wise progression, and assessment completion rates.
5. Ensure meaningful participation of persons with disabilities, with a target of at least 10% representation, including their active engagement in pilot testing, feedback, and course improvement processes.
6. Ensure gender-responsive participation, with targeted inclusion and active engagement of women with disabilities.

7. Provide regular progress reports, including disaggregated data (e.g., gender, disability type where appropriate), performance analytics, and actionable insights for course improvement.

3.8. Data Protection & Ethics

1. Ensure full compliance with data privacy and protection standards, including secure handling, storage, and processing of participant data.
2. Obtain informed consent from all participants for any data collection, including participation tracking, recordings, and use of testimonials (video, audio, or written).
3. Ensure that all data collection and use are conducted in an ethical, inclusive, and non-discriminatory manner, respecting the dignity and rights of persons with disabilities.

3.9. Ownership & Intellectual Property

All content, materials, and outputs developed under this assignment will be the property of a2i & UNDP, with full rights for reuse, adaptation, translation, and scaling for future initiatives and platforms.

3.10. Evaluation, Reporting & Knowledge Transfer

- Conduct post-training evaluation and participant satisfaction assessments, including qualitative and quantitative feedback.
- Assess learning outcomes through pre- and post-training evaluations, where applicable.
- Prepare a comprehensive final report capturing performance against targets, key insights, lessons learned, challenges, and actionable recommendations.
- Provide disaggregated analysis (e.g., gender, disability inclusion, engagement levels) to inform future improvements.
- Support knowledge transfer to relevant stakeholders (e.g., a2i, government agencies, partners) to ensure sustainability, institutionalization, and future scaling of the courses.

3. 11. Certification & Completion Criteria

Participants will be eligible for certification upon:

- Achieving a minimum of **70% score** in assessments
- Completing all required course modules and activities

Certificates will be:

- **Government-endorsed** (through a2i or relevant authority)
- **Digitally verifiable**, ensuring authenticity and ease of validation

4. Methodology

The firm is expected to adopt a participatory, user-centered, and accessibility-first methodology for the design, development, deployment, and delivery of the two e-learning courses. The methodology should ensure technical quality, inclusivity, scalability, and sustainability of the learning solutions.

4.1 Inception and Needs Assessment

The firm will conduct an inception phase to validate the scope, stakeholder expectations, learner profiles, and technical requirements.

This phase should include:

- Review of existing policies, guidelines, and relevant studies related to digital accessibility and disability inclusion in Bangladesh
- Stakeholder consultations with government agencies, Organizations of Persons with Disabilities (OPDs), academia, developers, accessibility experts, and development partners
- Identification of target learner groups, learning needs, and accessibility requirements
- Assessment of MuktoPaath platform requirements and technical constraints
- Submission of a detailed inception report including methodology, implementation approach, workplan, risk mitigation measures, and quality assurance mechanisms

4.2 Human-Centered and Inclusive Design Approach

The firm shall adopt a human-centered design (HCD) approach throughout the assignment to ensure that the courses are practical, inclusive, engaging, and responsive to the needs of diverse learners.

The approach should include:

- User journey mapping and learner experience analysis
- Co-creation and validation sessions with persons with disabilities and representative user groups
- Iterative design and feedback loops throughout content development
- Inclusive instructional design practices to accommodate different learning preferences and accessibility needs
- Gender-responsive and disability-inclusive participation strategies

4.3 Instructional Design and Curriculum Development

The courses should follow internationally recognized instructional design principles and adult learning methodologies.

The firm will:

- Develop structured learning pathways with clear learning objectives and competency outcomes
- Use modular and micro-learning approaches where appropriate
- Apply blended learning techniques including video lectures, demonstrations, practical exercises, case studies, quizzes, and downloadable resources
- Ensure consistency through standardized module templates
- Integrate real-life Bangladesh context, examples, and case studies

The methodology should promote practical application of knowledge rather than theory-only learning.

4.4 Accessibility-by-Design Approach

Accessibility must be integrated from the earliest stages of course design and production rather than added retroactively.

The firm shall:

- Apply WCAG 2.2 AA standards across all learning materials and digital interfaces
- Ensure compatibility with assistive technologies including screen readers and keyboard navigation
- Incorporate accessibility features such as captions, transcripts, alt text, accessible documents, semantic structure, and appropriate color contrast
- Include accessibility testing throughout development and prior to deployment
- Engage persons with disabilities in accessibility validation and usability testing

4.5 Use of Open-Source and Scalable Solutions

The firm is encouraged to utilize open-source tools, reusable learning assets, and interoperable solutions where feasible to support long-term sustainability and future scaling.

The methodology should:

- Maximize the use of existing open educational resources, templates, and accessibility frameworks where appropriate
- Avoid unnecessary proprietary dependencies where equivalent open-source options are available
- Ensure all source files and editable assets are transferable to a2i and UNDP
- Support future adaptation, localization, translation, and expansion of course content

4.6 Audio-Visual Production Methodology

The firm shall follow a structured production workflow to ensure high-quality and engaging multimedia content.

The workflow should include:

- Scriptwriting and storyboard approval prior to production

- Development of sample modules for validation before full-scale production
- Professional recording, editing, sound design, and post-production
- Integration of demonstrations, practical examples, animations, and case-based learning
- Quality assurance reviews for technical accuracy, accessibility, and instructional effectiveness

4.7 Quality Assurance and Pilot Testing

A continuous quality assurance process shall be applied throughout the assignment.

The methodology should include:

- Internal technical and editorial review processes
- Accessibility compliance validation
- Pilot testing with diverse learners, including persons with disabilities
- Collection and analysis of user feedback
- Iterative refinement of course content and platform usability based on findings

4.8 Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning (MEL)

The firm shall establish a results-based monitoring framework to track learning outcomes, engagement, accessibility performance, and inclusion targets.

The MEL approach should include:

- Baseline and endline assessments
- Pre- and post-training evaluations
- Monitoring of learner participation, progression, completion, and assessment performance
- Collection of disaggregated data where appropriate
- Regular reporting with actionable insights and recommendations for improvement

4.9 Knowledge Transfer and Sustainability

The methodology should ensure sustainability and institutional ownership beyond the project duration.

The firm shall:

- Build the capacity of trainers and relevant stakeholders through ToT sessions
- Provide documentation, editable source files, guides, and technical handover materials
- Support institutionalization and future scaling of the courses within government systems and learning platforms
- Ensure that all developed materials remain reusable and adaptable for future accessibility and digital inclusion initiatives in Bangladesh.

4. Key Deliverables & Timeline

No full-scale production shall proceed without approval of sample module and scripts.

#	Deliverable	Description of Outputs	Timeline	Tentative Date	Payment (%)
1	Inception Report & Workplan	- Detailed methodology (instructional design + accessibility approach) - Stakeholder consultation plan - Detailed workplan with milestones - MEL framework (KPIs, pre/post assessment design)	Within 2 weeks of contract signing	30 June 2026	10%
2	Curriculum & Instructional Design Package	- Final course structure for DAT & DDT - 25–30 modules with objectives, duration, and sequencing - Detailed module-wise content outlines - Assessment framework (quizzes, pre/post tests)	Within 1 month of contract signing	20 July 2026	15%
3	Scripts & Content Development Package	- Scripts for 100% video content (Bangla/English as required) - Storyboards for all modules - Reading materials (min. 1 per module) - Draft downloadable resources (min. 40+)	Within 2 months of contract signing	20 August 2026	15%
4	Audio-Visual Production Package	- 15–20 hours of HD video content (1080p) - Demonstrations and case studies included - 1 promo video (<1 minute) - Edited and raw files submitted	Within 3 months of contract signing	20 September 2026	20%
5	Accessibility Compliance Package	- Subtitles (SRT) for all videos - Transcripts for all modules - Screen reader-compatible	Within 3.5 months of contract signing	05 October 2026	10%

		documents - Sign language (where applicable) - WCAG 2.2 AA compliance validation report			
6	Platform Integration & Deployment (MuktoPaath)	- Full course upload (DAT & DDT) - Configured modules, navigation, assessments, certification - Accessibility features enabled - User Acceptance Testing (UAT) completed	Within 4 months of contract signing	20 October 2026	10%
7	Pilot Testing & ToT Delivery	- Pilot conducted with diverse users (incl. PwDs) - Feedback report and course refinement - ToT conducted for at least 20 trainers - ToT materials (facilitator guide, slides)	Within 4.5 months of contract signing	05 November 2026	10%
8	Training Rollout & Monitoring	- Ongoing monitoring of at least 500 participants - Monthly progress reports (completion, engagement, inclusion metrics) - Evidence of ≥30% learning improvement - ≥10% participation of persons with disabilities	Throughout implementation period	30 November 2026	5%
9	Final Report & Knowledge Transfer	- Final evaluation report (quantitative & qualitative) - Learning outcomes and analytics - Lessons learned and recommendations - Full handover of all source files, datasets, and materials	End of assignment	30 November 2026	5%

5. Duration & Duty Station

- **Duration:** Approximately 5.5 months starting from June 2026